PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #47 · ANXIETY

"These feelings in my body mean I'm about to lose control."

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Where it often comes from

Panic teaches the body to fear itself. A racing heart, dizziness, a tight throat, or a sudden heat can feel like the beginning of collapse, fainting, or "going crazy." Once that interpretation sticks, the sensation becomes the emergency. Anxiety disorders often work this way: the body fires, the mind names it catastrophe, and the name makes the body fire harder. The sensation is real. The meaning "I am losing control" is the belief to test.

What Scripture teaches

God is a refuge and strength, an ever-present help, including when the body is loud. He has not given a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control. The psalmist brings overwhelming anxiety to God and finds consolation. Jesus says not to let your heart be troubled, and He gives His peace. "Do not fear, for I am with you" is spoken to people whose bodies know fear. None of these verses say a pounding heart means you are about to lose your mind or your life. They say God is present and you are not abandoned to the sensation.

> *"God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble"* (Psalm 46:1).

Also see

> "For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control" (2 Timothy 1:7).

> "When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul" (Psalm 94:19).

> "Peace I leave with you; My peace I give to you. I do not give to you as the world gives. Do not let your hearts be troubled; do not be afraid" (John 14:27).

> "Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness" (Isaiah 41:10).

Common self-statements

- I am about to faint, die, or lose my mind.
- I have to escape or it will get worse forever.
- If people see this, I will completely fall apart.
- My body is warning me of something terrible.
- I cannot trust myself when I feel this way.
- Calm is the only proof I am all right.

Common logical errors

- Catastrophizing: Turning a body sensation into collapse, death, or madness.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling out of control and concluding that you are.
- Fortune telling: Predicting the sensation will keep rising until you break.
- Discounting the positive: Forgetting the many times this same wave passed.

Challenging questions

- What is my body doing, in plain words, without the disaster label?
- How many times has this feeling peaked and then come down?

- What would I do if a friend described these exact sensations?
- Am I in a place where I can sit, breathe, and wait ten minutes?
- What does “God is our refuge” mean while my heart is racing?
- Is there a real medical question to ask a doctor, separate from the panic story?

Truth summary

> A racing body is not the same as losing control. I can feel anxious and still be safe.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

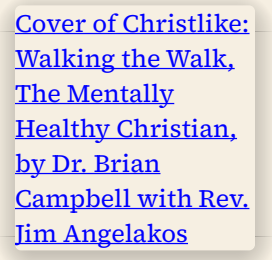
- Anxiety/Worry
- Fear
- Peace
- Help
- Thinking, Healthy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Anxiety/Worry/Fear
- Weak/Tired
- Thinking, Healthy

What does a mentally healthy Christian look like?



From *Christlike: Walking the Walk* by Dr. Brian Campbell. A portrait, verse by verse, of how a mentally healthy Christian thinks, feels, and lives.

Read excerpts from “The Mentally Healthy Christian” (with every Scripture written out)

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Listen: Overcoming Depression

Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Same Power — Jeremy Camp

God's power holds you when your body feels out of control.

Fear Is a Liar — Zach Williams
A pounding heart can lie about what is happening.

Worn — Tenth Avenue North
You can be worn out in your body and still ask God to restore you.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
Christ's gentleness meets you in the panic. You do not have to hide it.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, what is one step I could take today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "These feelings in my body mean I'm about to lose control."

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"These feelings in my body mean I'm about to lose control." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What is my body doing, in plain words, without the disaster label?
- ☐ How many times has this feeling peaked and then come down?
- ☐ What would I do if a friend described these exact sensations?
- ☐ Am I in a place where I can sit, breathe, and wait ten minutes?
- ☐ What does "God is our refuge" mean while my heart is racing?
- ☐ Is there a real medical question to ask a doctor, separate from the panic story?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ A racing body is not the same as losing control. I can feel anxious and still be safe.
- ☐ This sensation is anxiety. It is not proof I am collapsing.
- ☐ I have felt this before and I did not lose control.
- ☐ God is a refuge while my body is loud.
- ☐ I can breathe, stay, and let the wave pass.
- ☐ Self-control is something God gives, not something the feeling cancels.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 46:1
  "God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble."
- ☐ 2 Timothy 1:7
  "For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control."
- ☐ Psalm 94:19
  "When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When your body felt like an emergency: Each day, write down one moment when a sensation felt like losing control. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 46:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God is my refuge while my heart races. This feeling can pass.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Anxiety/Worry" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Describe, do not diagnose. When the wave comes, write only sensations: heart, breath, heat. Do not add "I am dying" or "I am losing it."
- [ ] Stay for the peak. If you are not in medical danger, remain where you are for ten minutes and note that the wave changes.
- [ ] Recall three passed waves. Write them down and keep the note where you will see it.
- [ ] Ask a doctor once if a symptom truly worries you, then stop using new sensations as fresh proof of disaster.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "These feelings in my body mean I'm about to lose control.": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A body wave that passed
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~These feelings in my body mean I'm about to lose control~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, my body is loud and I am scared of it. Be my refuge here. Give me a sound mind, and help me let this wave pass without calling it the end. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.